

Sandshrew

The Earth rift's companion and the roster's tank. It holds ground, takes the hit meant for a friend, and makes the dirt around it hard to cross.

The Underroot's own answer to a charge. Sandshrew plants itself between the party and whatever is coming, dares the whole pack to come through him, and makes the ground they would have to cross buck and split beneath them.

SANDSHREW

Medium beast (Ground), unaligned ◆ Earth-rift companion

AC 17 (natural armor) **HP** 78 (12d8 + 24) **Speed** 30 ft., burrow 40 ft.

STR 18 **DEX** 14 **CON** 15 **INT** 6 **WIS** 12 **CHA** 10

Saves Str +7, Con +5 **Skills** Athletics +7, Perception +4

Vulnerable cold

Resist bludgeoning, piercing, and slashing from nonmagical attacks

Senses darkvision 60 ft., tremorsense 30 ft., passive Perception 14

Languages understands its handler, speaks none

Traits

Sand Veil. Dust curls constantly from its plates. Attack rolls against Sandshrew made from more than 15 feet away have Disadvantage.

Curl Up. *Reaction.* When Sandshrew is hit by an attack, it tucks behind its plates. Reduce that attack's damage by 10.

Actions

Multiattack. It makes two Claw attacks.

Claw. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +8 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 10 (1d10 + 5) slashing damage.

Challenge. *Bonus Action, 30 ft., one enemy that can see it.* Sandshrew rears up with a rattling hiss and dares that one to try it. Until the start of Sandshrew's next turn, the target has Disadvantage on attack rolls against any target other than Sandshrew.

Earthquake. Sandshrew slams both forefeet down and the ground bucks and splits in a 20-foot Cube centered on itself. Each creature of Sandshrew's choice in that area makes a DC 15 Dexterity saving throw, taking 10 (3d6) Bludgeoning damage on a failed save, or half as much damage on a successful one. The broken ground is Difficult Terrain until the start of Sandshrew's next turn.

